

Personal Expense Tracker — Project Report

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Course: Python Programming

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1. Introduction

At some point, most of us have asked ourselves:

“Where did all my money go?”

Even when we think we aren’t spending much, small everyday expenses — snacks, travel, subscriptions, random online purchases — slowly add up. I personally noticed that I wasn’t tracking how much I spent, and by the end of every month, it felt like money just disappeared.

That’s what gave me the idea for this project. I wanted a simple tool that could help record expenses and show spending patterns without needing a complicated app or online account. Something lightweight, quick to use, and easy to understand. So, I decided to build a **Personal Expense Tracker using Python**.

2. Purpose of the Project

The goal of this project is straightforward:

to help a person keep track of their daily expenses in a way that doesn’t feel like a burden.

Instead of relying on memory or notes on paper (which we often forget or lose), this program stores every entered expense in a CSV file, making it easy to review and organize later.

3. Why This Matters

Money management isn’t just for working professionals — students also need it. We deal with:

- Food expenses
- Transport
- Events
- Online orders

- Entertainment
- Subscriptions (which we often forget renew automatically)

Without tracking, it's very easy to overspend without realizing it. This project acts as a small step toward better financial discipline.

4. How the System Works

The program shows a menu when it starts, and the user can choose what they want to do:

- Add a new expense
- View previous entries
- Check total spending
- Filter spending by category
- Or exit

Every time an expense is added, it gets saved into a file called **expenses.csv**. Even if the program is closed, the information remains stored and can be opened later in Excel or Google Sheets.

5. Technologies Used

Tool / Module Why It Was Used

Python	The main programming language
csv	To store and read expense data
os	To check if the file already exists
datetime	Automatically saves the current date

6. Project Features

- Automatically creates a CSV file if it's not present
- Stores date, category, amount, and description
- Shows all expenses in a clean format

- Displays total money spent
 - Filters expenses by category like Food, Travel, Bills, etc.
 - Simple and interactive command-line interface
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7. Example CSV Entry

```
--- Expense History ---
Date | Category | Amount | Description
2025-11-24 | Travel | 5000 | Manali trip
2025-11-24 | Food | 24666 | dgfdghf
2025-11-24 | Others | 748939581204 | its business
```

8. Challenges Faced

One of the challenges was making sure the program didn't overwrite the file every time it ran. Handling user input cleanly was another area I had to adjust multiple times so that the program felt smooth and not confusing.

9. Future Improvements

There is a lot of scope to make this project more advanced. Some ideas I may work on later are:

- Adding charts or graphs to visualize spending
 - Monthly summary or analysis
 - A login system so multiple users can use it
 - Turning it into a GUI app using Tkinter or even a mobile/web app
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10. Conclusion

Building this Personal Expense Tracker helped me understand how even a simple idea can be useful in everyday life. It made me realize how important it is to track spending and how coding can solve real personal problems.

This project not only improved my Python skills, especially in file handling and structured programming, but it also motivated me to continue exploring practical applications of programming.

Overall, I enjoyed working on this project, and I believe it can genuinely help users become more aware of their spending habits.

End of Report